

Appendix C: Letter to the Southern Association of Schools and Colleges (SACS)

Southern Association of Schools and Colleges
Regional Headquarters
1866 Southern Lane
Decatur, Georgia 30033-4097

June 22, 2012

To Whom It May Concern:

XX University is submitting an application to the US Department of Education to begin a Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program (CTP) for individuals with intellectual disabilities, called the XX program name.

The students working toward their certificate will attend XX's main campus in XX. All general student services, academic services, and social events available at XXname of university will be open to students in the CTP. Upon completion of the CTP students will be better prepared to enter the world of work. The student will have learned work readiness skills, employability skills, social skills, and have received work experience. The core classes in the program provide the students with the skills they need to be successful in the work place and beyond.

Faculty and staff members who work with the students in the CTP will be provided support by the program. Program staff members can provide professors with the training and resources they will need to create modified syllabi and track student progress. Modified syllabi will be offered to students who are participating in an audit status, but syllabi will *not* be modified for students taking courses for credit.

In addition to these supports, the program will use a peer mentoring system to enhance the student's classroom and social experiences. A peer mentor is another student who can assist a student who may still be developing the skills for independence, such as a student with a disability. Students in the program will receive academic counseling from university advisors and professors, along with staff members from the program who are trained to address the educational needs of people with intellectual disabilities. The curriculum for each student will be individualized to incorporate the approved core classes of the program, as well as approved classes that are in the student's area of interest.

All courses included in the program are existing courses in the university catalog and open to *all* students. Students participating in the program will follow a traditional semester term which includes 16 weeks of instructional time. Each student will typically enroll for six or seven credit hours per semester. The classes can be audited or taken for credit. Twenty six (26) hours of coursework will be required – either taken for credit or audited. The program will require a minimum of three supervised internships related to the student's career goal. Internships can be paid or non-paid. In addition, students will

be expected to have their work internships/work-based training in settings with individuals without disabilities.

Our philosophy is one of facilitating natural supports for social inclusion. All students who participate in the program will be able to participate in all university social clubs and organizations with or without their mentor. Facilitating natural supports and inclusion within the social aspect of college life may include helping the student identify extracurricular activities he or she is interested in pursuing; determining how to balance social and academic life; fostering friendships with students who have similar interests.

Students will be taking classes that are open to all students. Our philosophy is one of looking for natural supports to academic inclusion which will vary from student to student. Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) will be determined using a person-centered planning approach. For students who are enrolled in their certificate ***coursework for credit***, satisfactory progress will be determined by satisfactory grade point average (GPA), as required for all students of a 2.0 GPA, plus satisfactory performance in work internships (with a rating of at least “Expected Progress” on their internship goals). For students who are enrolled in their classes ***on an audit basis***, the goals will be determined and agreed upon for each student through the collaboration of the student, the student’s professors, and the campus coordinator staff. A rubric will be used to identify and quantify the student’s goals and progress for each course.

Minimum Requirements for the Program Certificate of Accomplishment:

- 1) 26 hours of coursework – either taken for credit or audited. If courses are audited, modified assignments tied to both course content and specific career and or life goals must be included. Course of study (26 hour program) will be individually determined in relation to student goals. For students who are auditing, satisfactory academic progress will be measured by performance on individually modified assignments. Program professional staff will work in collaboration with course instructors to modify course assignments, so as not to create additional responsibilities for faculty.
- 2) Minimum of three supervised internships related to career goal. Internships can be paid or non-paid.
- 3) Student portfolio of accomplishments is required for completion of the program. Portfolio will include examples of assignments or projects for courses taken for credit; modified course assignments or projects for audited classes; examples of skills obtained through internships; and may also include examples of leadership or service learning activities on campus or in the community, extra-curricular involvement, etc.

Courses:

- Core CCE Classes:
 - REA 100- 1 credit hour
 - FYE 098- 1 credit hour

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- REC/MUS- 1 credit hour
- COM 131- 3 credit hours
- Area 099- 1 credit hour
- HEA 191- 3 credit hours
- YNL 290- 3 credit hours
- Electives:
 - AGR- 099, 100, 101, 180, 199, 361
 - ART 105, 121
 - BPA- 099, 140
 - COM- 161
 - EDU 099, 201, 202
 - ENG- 095
 - FCS 111, 210, 234
 - GCM- 099, 150, 151, 153, 250, 488
 - GUI 100, 188
 - HEA 195
 - MUS 104, 105, 106, 107, 108
 - NTN- 099, 200, 220, 230, 231, 488
 - PSY 180
 - REC- 099, 101, 102, 113, 118, 120, 150, 207, 421
 - SOC 133
 - THD 099, 101, 104, 110, 111, 260
 - YNL- 099, 350

Sample Curriculum:

Year 1- Fall	Year 1 – Spring	Year 2- Fall	Year 2- Spring
REA 100 - Fundamental Reading Skills (1)	COM 131- Introduction to Interpersonal Communication (3)	HEA 191- Personal Health (3)	YNL 290- Trends and Issues in Youth and Human Services (3)
FYE 098- New Student Orientation I (1)	Area 099 (1)	Area Elective (3)	Area Elective (3)
REC/MUS (1)	FYE 100- Freshman Orientation II (1)	Internship (1)	Internship (1)
Area Elective (3)	Internship (1)		
6 Credit Hours	6 Credit Hours	7 Credit Hours	7 Credit Hours

The anticipated outcomes for students participating in the program are:

1. Competitive Employment- Students who complete the program will be better prepared for the world of work having gained job seeking skills, a knowledge of work etiquette, and skills specific to their chosen specialty.
2. Socialization- Through participating in a fully inclusive college experience, the students will gain interpersonal skills that will benefit them both vocationally and socially.
3. Self-esteem- The very act of completing the coursework needed to receive the program will provide the students with a greater sense of self-worth and self-esteem. This will be measured using pre/post interview data. The students will have supports including mentors, advisors, and program staff and resources; however, it will be expected that as they progress through the program, they will become increasingly more independent. This independence should expand beyond the college setting and into other aspects of their lives.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely: